

Nandi 2027: Research Session Record

A working record of the research conducted for Hon. Cynthia Muge's 2027 Nandi gubernatorial bid: what was produced, how the evidence was gathered, which earlier conclusions were corrected, and what remains unanswered.

Field	Detail
Subject	Hon. Cynthia Jepkosgei Muge, Woman Representative, Nandi County
Contest	Nandi County Governor, 2027 General Election
Decisive event	UDA nomination, estimated Q1 2027
Session date	27–29 August 2026
Client role	Videography, photography, design, sound, web development, research
Deliverables	4 published documents, 10 raw research files, 1 translation worksheet

How to read this record

This is a process document, not the research itself. The findings live in the four published documents listed in section 2; this file records how they were built, what changed, and what is still open, so the work can be picked up later or handed to someone else.

Evidence discipline carried over from the dossier: Verified means an official record or two independent sources. Reported means one credible outlet. Sentiment means public opinion, which is signal about mood and not about fact. Reading means inference. Much of the material gathered in this session is partisan social-media assertion and is labelled as such.

1 Scope of the brief

The original brief asked for a comprehensive assessment covering twenty areas: a profile of the candidate, her political journey since 2017, campaign analysis, the Nandi political environment, socioeconomic context, competitors, a social media audit, public narrative analysis, the coffee programme, grassroots engagement, gender and cultural dynamics, digital platform strategy, SWOT, communication gaps, and where the client's own creative and technical skills contribute most.

Two constraints shaped the work. First, the client is a production specialist rather than a political operative, so the assessment repeatedly distinguishes what he can execute personally from what needs polling firms, lawyers or organisers. Second, the brief explicitly asked that findings be traceable to sources, with verified fact kept separate from sentiment and inference.

2 Deliverables produced

#	Document	What it is	Status
1	The Nandi Succession	The strategic dossier. 20 sections covering profile, competitors, narrative, coffee programme, culture, platforms, SWOT, gaps, and the client's role.	Published Revised to v2
2	The Tree in Her Name	Documentary treatment and shot list. 24-minute film on Kahawa na Mama; 15 scenes, ~70 shots, ethics protocol, schedule, kit list, six deliverables.	Published v1
3	Sixteen Weeks Vertical	A 16-short vertical video series for TikTok and Facebook, October to January, with format spec, caption system, distribution chain and measurement.	Published v1
4	Nandi Translation Worksheet	28 Kalenjin lines and 14 terms needing a native speaker, ranked by how much the answer changes. Shareable with a translator.	Published Answered

Raw research files, saved to [research/facebook/](#)

File	Contents
CRITIQUE_kibitok.md	Full text of the strongest critique found, with analysis
thread_tally.md	204-comment preference thread, tallied
youthbunge_FULL.md	151K-member group, full-text harvest
supporter_FULL.md	64.5K supporter group, full-text harvest
opposition_hub.md	Opposition-leaning group: second poll, elders, attacks
rerun_FULL.md	Political Arena and County Forum, expanded
nandihills_muge.md	Nandi Hills forum, two search passes
arena_and_supporters.md, nandicountyforum.md, youthbunge.md	Earlier truncated passes, retained for provenance

3 Method and access

The research ran in two distinct phases, and the second phase is what makes this session worth documenting.

Phase one — indexed sources

Web search, official records and public social profiles. Sources included the Kenyan Parliament site, Mzalendo's parliamentary scorecard, TransTally election results, the Controller of Budget, Kenya News Agency, The Star, Daily Nation, and the candidate's own website. Social data came from TikTok, X and Instagram searches.

The limitation: Facebook group discussion — where Nandi's political argument actually happens — was login-walled. The first version of the dossier named this as its highest-priority research gap.

Phase two — inside the groups

The client joined fourteen Nandi County Facebook groups and logged in through the built-in browser. That opened the walled layer. Each group was searched, posts were expanded past their “See more” truncation, and comment threads were loaded in full.

Two access problems worth recording, because they will recur

1. The Chrome extension route failed. Claude in Chrome never connected in this session. The working route was logging into Facebook inside the built-in browser pane instead — faster to set up and it worked immediately. Note that the opencli adapter has a live Facebook session but no command to read group posts, which is a capability gap rather than a fault.

2. Truncation nearly cost the research its best finding. Early passes captured only the text before each post's “See more” link, which meant reading headlines rather than arguments. Once expansion was fixed and the groups re-run, the full text produced several of the most important findings in this record — including the audit critique in section 5 and the tournament figures. **Any future harvest must expand posts before extracting.**

Coverage achieved

Group	Members	Yield
NANDI COUNTY FORUM (NandiYouthBunge)	151K	Rich — full-text harvest
Cynthia Muge 3rd Governor	64.5K	Rich — supporter base, BOSO figures
NANDI COUNTY FORUM (opposition-leaning)	—	Rich — second poll, elders, attacks
NANDI HILLS CONSTITUENCY FORUM	50K	Rich — the rejection story at source
NANDI COUNTY FORUM (var.)	219K	Moderate — preference thread
NEW NANDIHILLS CONSTITUENCY PROGRESS	8.9K	The Kibitok critique
Seven further Nandi groups	—	Thin — cross-posted duplicates
LANGAS YETU	—	Excluded — Uasin Gishu, not Nandi

Two private groups (169K and 105K members) remained pending admin approval. WhatsApp, which the dossier identifies as the real organising channel in Kenya, is closed to research entirely and remains the one unread layer.

4 Corrections register

Four conclusions from the first pass were wrong and have been corrected in the published dossier. They are listed here because a reader who saw the earlier version, or who works from notes taken during it, may still be carrying them.

Correction 1 — The cultural attack is not about circumcision

Was: The dossier treated circumcision status as the likely vector of the cultural attack, reasoning that such discourse lives in spaces the research could not reach.

Is: Across fourteen groups, hundreds of posts and 204 comments on one thread, **circumcision does not appear once**. The live attack is that she wore *sinendet*, a ceremonial plant worn on formal occasions, and that women do not wear it.

Why it matters: This is materially better ground. It is a factual claim that can be checked, it is not a slur, and the thread's own author replied "What is this about sinendet again?" — the line is tired, not fresh.

Correction 2 — She is not undocumented, she is unverifiable

Was: The dossier concluded she had no owned media operation and that the core problem was a production gap.

Is: At least twenty surrogate pages publish her work daily — CYNTHIA MUGE PRESS UNIT, Cynthia Muge MEDIA, Nandi Updates, The Third Eye, Nandi Civic Voice, Nandi Daily, Nandi Lioness, Back Up, Vee Jeptoo KE, George Maiyo GM and others.

Why it matters: The diagnosis changes from production to verification, which is cheaper to fix. It also means her camp cannot cleanly allege coordination against rivals — the "not because she is a WOMAN" post appears near-verbatim from two posters, so her side runs the same copy-paste technique Melly's does.

Correction 3 — Kimasas runs the other way

Was: Logged as an unverified land allegation circulating against her.

Is: It is an attack *she* makes against the Kosgey family. Their camp pushes back: "whenever elections are approaching, you always resort to talking about Kimasas."

Correction 4 — The sports tournaments were misread

Was: Treated as a vanity strand and a liability, on the strength of a jibe about "that one with the tournament."

Is: The BOSO Supercup reached **all 30 wards with 499 teams, 846 matches and 83 playing fields in three months**, with KSh 2.7 million in ward prize money, for both men and women. That is a county-wide organising network, and its grand finale falls in December 2026 — immediately before nominations.

Caveat, which is also true: the spending is a real vulnerability. Two separate critiques ask how many young people have a livelihood after the final whistle. Both things hold at once.

5 Principal new findings

5.1 The accountability critique

The most consequential single document found. Written by Robert Kibitok and circulating in the Nandi Hills groups, it is sober, specific and carries no gender or cultural content, which is precisely what makes it hard to answer.

Quoted in part

“How many seedlings came from NGAAF? How many came from the National Government? Who supplied them? At what price? Which women's groups received them? Which wards benefited?

And the biggest question: **if you give a women's group coffee seedlings but there is no factory or clear market around them, what happens when those trees mature?** Do we just celebrate the planting ceremony and leave the farmer to figure out the rest?

And what about the Nandi woman who doesn't need coffee? The mama mboga? The boda boda rider? The small trader? The unemployed graduate? The PWD? Where is their empowerment programme?

Bring the numbers. Bring the beneficiary lists. Bring the procurement records. ... let's stop confusing visibility with impact.”

It identifies a hole no earlier research had named: **the market question**. The programme creates supply with no established buyer or processing capacity. It also names the breadth problem — a coffee programme serves coffee farmers only.

5.2 Four measurements, one direction

Measurement	Kosgey	Muge	Melly	Caveat
Darubini Research, ~Jun 2026	48%	28%	17%	Methodology unpublished
Nandi Civic Voice poll, 713 votes	29.7%	25.5%	19.1%	Online; run by a pro-Muge page
Comment-thread tally, 204 comments	36.8%	40.4%	22.2%	Thread seeded pro-Muge
Mizani Africa X poll, 321 votes	—	—	—	Withheld; brigaded by both camps

All four are weak. But Kosgey leads or ties in every measurement not seeded in Muge's favour, and Melly is third in all of them. The twenty-point Darubini gap does not reproduce; the direction does.

The Nandi Civic Voice poll also surfaced three candidates absent from all press coverage: **Stanley Baliach at 12.8 per cent** (fourth), Joshua Kiptoo at 6.9, and **Dr. Yulita Mitei**, a second woman in the field. Cleophas Lagat took 1.5 per cent, which suggests the comeback narrative is not registering online.

5.3 Coordinated seeding, on both sides

Identical text — “Hon. Julius Melly is currently setting the pace in the Nandi gubernatorial contest, with Allan Kosgey following closely in second and Cynthia Muge in third” — was found posted by six accounts across five groups, traced to **Mtetezi Mtetezi (@TeamMtetezi001)**, **162,700 followers**, posting it repeatedly within hours.

Coordination is proven. Payment is not, and should not be alleged. Muge's camp meanwhile accused a rival of using fake accounts to win an online poll while soliciting votes for that same poll. **No camp's claimed ordering is independent evidence.**

5.4 Elders as the institutional battleground

The **Talai Council of Elders** has publicly blessed Allan Kosgey's candidacy, announced from Kapsisiyo. Separately, Muge attended and publicised the installation of the National Chairman of the **Nandi Kaburwo Council of Elders** at Baraton. She is contesting the same ground through a different council, which reads as deliberate. The relative standing of the two councils is not established.

5.5 A delivery record larger than first found

Programme	Documented scale
Kahawa na Mama	650,000+ seedlings, ~4,000 women, all six sub-counties. Phase III target of 1.5 million. Includes a spousal joint-registration charter.
Elimu Ni Mwangaza	449 students on full scholarship, 206 sitting KCSE in 2026. Pioneer cohort entered Form One in 2023.
BOSO Supercup	All 30 wards, 499 teams, 846 matches, 83 fields, KSh 2.7m prize money, men and women. Finale December 2026.
Empowerment cheques	KSh 100,000 per group across multiple wards, women and youth groups named.
Infrastructure	Boda boda shades at Ndalat and Kapkilel. Water, school and healthcare strands referenced but undocumented.

6 Translation results

Twenty-eight Kalenjin lines and fourteen terms were extracted verbatim and given to a native speaker. The translator described the results as rough and partly non-literal, and they should be treated that way. They nonetheless resolved the largest open question in the research.

Term or line	Translation given	Consequence
oripoo	"Tulia" — calm down; to bow in a show of respect	Not an obscenity. The charge is status inversion, not vulgarity. Context decides everything.
chepyoso	Women	Not a slur. The comments using it are objections, not abuse.
sinendet	A cultural rope plant worn on ceremonial occasions	The actual cultural attack. Checkable and answerable.
cheptilda	A nickname given to her	Not a smear. Used on both sides — one instance means "she gives us coffee."
cheptikonyool	"The bringer of gifts", or "the posture that is right"	Her own nickname, positive in both readings.
kityo	"Pekee" — only, alone	Confirms the comment tally: these are genuine endorsements.
maloo saboon	Something good is coming	Kosgey's core slogan.
legetyo rah	This time it is the woman	A Muge slogan, not a generic phrase.
Kasomook eng kaminninget ab kee	"I have asked you humbly"	Caption on her best-performing post ever. Her top content is humility, not fire.

The two attack lines, in full

"Moberberi lakwanaa tomo koyam kondoiwech chepyoso" — *That child, let us not deceive each other, the time has not yet come for her to lead us.* Age and gender fused in one sentence.

"Mitei lelwek jeingin kole Cynthia kikokere ngo chepyoso neilakjin sinendet suet how" — *Who has ever seen a woman wearing sinendet at the waist?* The ceremonial-protocol charge.

7 Open questions

Priority	Question	Why it matters
1	The original <i>oripoo</i> clip	The word means “calm down”. If she said it to a rowdy crowd, the controversy is a deliberate misreading. Nobody holds the footage, which is why a mild phrase became a scandal.
2	Coffee market and processing capacity	Kibitok's question. Is there a factory, a buyer, and absorptive capacity for 1.5 million trees? The largest open question attached to her signature programme.
3	Seedling survival rate, measured	A 90 per cent figure is circulating from a supporter's spreadsheet, presented as fact. Count trees before anyone prints it.
4	Did she wear <i>sinendet</i> , and do women ever wear it?	A photograph and one elder's counter-example would close a recurring attack permanently.
5	Talai versus Kaburwo	Kosgey holds one council's blessing. There is no basis yet to judge what that is worth.
6	SRC gazetted pay scales	A detailed salary attack is circulating with figures that are largely false. A sourced graphic would end it; a denial would not.
7	Stanley Baliach	Polling fourth with no press coverage. Sleeper candidate or artefact of an online poll.
8	Her own drifting numbers	Scholarships appear as 409 and 449; the target as 3,500, 4,000 and 120 per ward; the launch year as 2022 and 2023; the programme under two names. Each is a loaded gun in a race where her core vulnerability is that she cannot be checked.

8 Recommended next actions

Immediate, this week

- **Confirm the local coffee harvest window** with Baraka Agricultural College or the county AFA office. The entire documentary schedule hangs on it, and if the main crop starts in October there are roughly five weeks of prep.
- **Verify seedling survival and whether any beneficiary has sold cherry.** This is the documentary's kill-criteria check: if outcomes are weak, the film should not be made as planned.
- **Pin the drifting figures** before anything is published anywhere.
- **Start caption discipline on every post.** Free, immediate, and worth roughly an order of magnitude of reach.

September

- Cast the four farmers for the film, in Nandi Hills first. No camera on the first visit.
- Collect 2023 photographs of planted plots — without them the before-and-after does not exist.
- Build the ward-coordinator WhatsApp list, one contact per ward across thirty wards.
- Agree in writing that the honest-failure scene ships and that end-card figures are the measured ones.

October to January

- Principal photography across the harvest window; the harvest scenes cannot be rescheduled.
- Publish one vertical short a week from October, plus same-day capture of every public appearance.
- Build the December BOSO finale into the campaign calendar as a filmed set-piece.
- Deliver the film mid-January, ahead of nominations, with a screening tour of the six sub-counties.

A standing caution on the evidence

Much of what was gathered in phase two is unverified assertion by partisans on both sides. Three items in particular should not be repeated as fact by anyone on the campaign: the allegation that a rival used fake accounts to win an online poll; the claim that women were given a script to insult her and refused; and the circulating salary figures, which are demonstrably wrong.

A related risk sits inside her own camp's content. One supporter post claims she "completed over 99 per cent of the county's development projects" — a Woman Representative does not deliver county projects, and that claim would not survive a debate.

9 File inventory

Path	Contents
nandi-succession.html	The dossier, v2. Published and watched for changes.
tree-in-her-name.html	Documentary treatment and shot list.
sixteen-weeks.html	Vertical shorts series.
translation-worksheet.html	Kalenjin lines for the translator; now answered.
research/facebook/*.md	Ten raw harvest files with verbatim quotes and engagement data.
Session-Record-2026-08-29.pdf	This document.

Compiled 29 August 2026. The four published documents are the deliverables; this file is the record of how they were made and what remains unresolved. Every factual claim here traces to the research files listed above or to the published dossier's own sources section.